

The Impact of Computer Graphics on Daily Life

SIGGRAPH 2022 Retrospective Panel

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1 OVERVIEW

During the history of the SIGGRAPH conference, computer graphics has evolved from research topic to innovative technology accessible only via industrial computing capacity to fundamental in how we learn, play and manage our daily lives. Panel members will talk about their experience as the industry has advanced and how graphics technology has changed how both creators and consumers experience art, entertainment, education and professional training.

2 BIOGRAPHIES

2.1 Jim Blinn

Jim Blinn made his first computer generated pictures in 1968 while an undergraduate at the University of Michigan. In 1977 he received a Ph.D. and moved to the Jet Propulsion Laboratory where he produced computer graphics animations for space missions to Jupiter, Saturn and Uranus. These animations were the first exposure to computer animation for many people in the industry. Also at JPL he produced animation for the PBS series COSMOS and for “The Mechanical Universe”, a telecourse to teach college-level physics. From 1989 to 1995 he worked at Caltech producing animations to teach High School mathematics for “Project Mathematics!”

2.2 Adele Newton

Adele Newton has recently retired from a career in developing and managing programs and strategic international partnerships in

the university, technology and not-for-profit sectors across North America and in Africa, Europe and China. Her work has focussed on connecting diverse partners from technology, science and the arts to collaborate on innovative projects. Adele served as SIGGRAPH 88 Conference Co-Chair and member of the Executive Committee. She is currently Chair of the SIGGRAPH Communications Committee.

2.3 Judith Crow

Thirty plus years in computer graphics has provided Judith with an appreciation of the confluence of technology, art, storytelling and teamwork. She brings a rich variety of experiences as an educator, digital artist, film digital FX supervisor, technology and production manager. While at SideFX Judith lead the initiative to bring Houdini’s proceduralism to games developers, and has recently assumed the role of VP Strategic Partnerships. These diverse roles have made it possible for her to communicate with artists, technologists and executives alike.

2.4 Rebecca Strzelec

Rebecca Strzelec, Distinguished Professor of Visual Arts and Program Coordinator of Visual Art Studies at Penn State Altoona, earned her BFA 2000 and MFA 2002 from Tyler School of Art, Temple University in Metals/Jewelry/CAD-CAM. Her work consists of wearable objects which are created via computer aided design, three-dimensional modeling, and 3D printing. Her work is included in the permanent collection of the Museum of Arts and Design in New York, Fuller Craft Museum, Racine Art Museum and the private collection of Former Secretary of State Madeleine Albright. Rebecca served as Chair of the SIGGRAPH 2012 conference.

2.5 Benjamin Lok

Benjamin Lok is Professor in the Computer and Information Sciences and Engineering Department at the University of Florida and entrepreneur, having previously co-founded Shadow Health (currently part of Elsevier). Professor Lok’s research focuses on using virtual humans and mixed reality to train communication skills within the areas of virtual environments, human-computer interaction, and computer graphics. Professor Lok received a Ph. D and M.S. University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill. Professor Lok was inducted into the inaugural IEEE VGTC VR Academy (2022), received the UF Innovator of the Year Award (2019) and a NSF Career Award (2007-2012).

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